Cool Tools, Cool Schools & The Rules

A practical AI workshop for North Central Washington · **AI Expo 2026 · Wenatchee · August 11**

Brought to you by the **AIGovOps Foundation × NCW Tech Alliance**

Ken Johnston & Bob Rapp

Why We're Here

You walked in at a 5 out of 10

Curious, maybe skeptical, definitely busy.

You'll leave at a 7 or 8

Confident, equipped, and ready to teach someone else.

How we get there

Three rules, four tools, and a whole lot of show-and-tell.

Who's Running This

Ken Johnston

AI & data leadership at **Microsoft, Ford,** and CEO of **Autonomic.ai** — building the future of connected vehicles and enterprise AI.

Bob Rapp

AI/ML at **Vodafone, IBM Watson, GE Healthcare, Microsoft,** and **General Motors** — translating frontier AI into real-world impact.

Together: AIGovOps Foundation

Open-source AI governance for **everyone** — not just enterprises. Built by practitioners, for communities like NCW.

Our Promise to You

💸 Free or Cheap

Every tool we show you costs nothing — or close to it.

🃏 Wallet-Card Simple

Every concept fits on a card you can carry home.

🔨 Build Something Real

Every minute, someone in this room creates something that works.

The 4-Part Recipe

The only framework you need today — and the one you'll use every day after.

PROBLEM

What's bugging me?

TASK

What do I want the AI to do?

ROLE

Who should the AI be?

OUTCOME

What shape do I want the answer in?

> *"Pat the donor → 3-sentence thank-you → warm small-town nonprofit director → mention the $50, no jargon."*

Live Demo: The Recipe in Action

Facilitator: open Gemini live. Type one prompt **missing the ROLE**. Show the boring result. Add the role. Show the great result. Don't read this slide — **DO it.**

Step 1: No Role

Generic, flat, forgettable. The AI doesn't know who it's talking to.

Step 2: Add the Role

Warm, specific, human. The AI knows exactly what voice to use.

Show and Tell #1

Same question. Three tools. You vote which answer you'd actually send.

Google Gemini

All-purpose, lives in your Google apps.

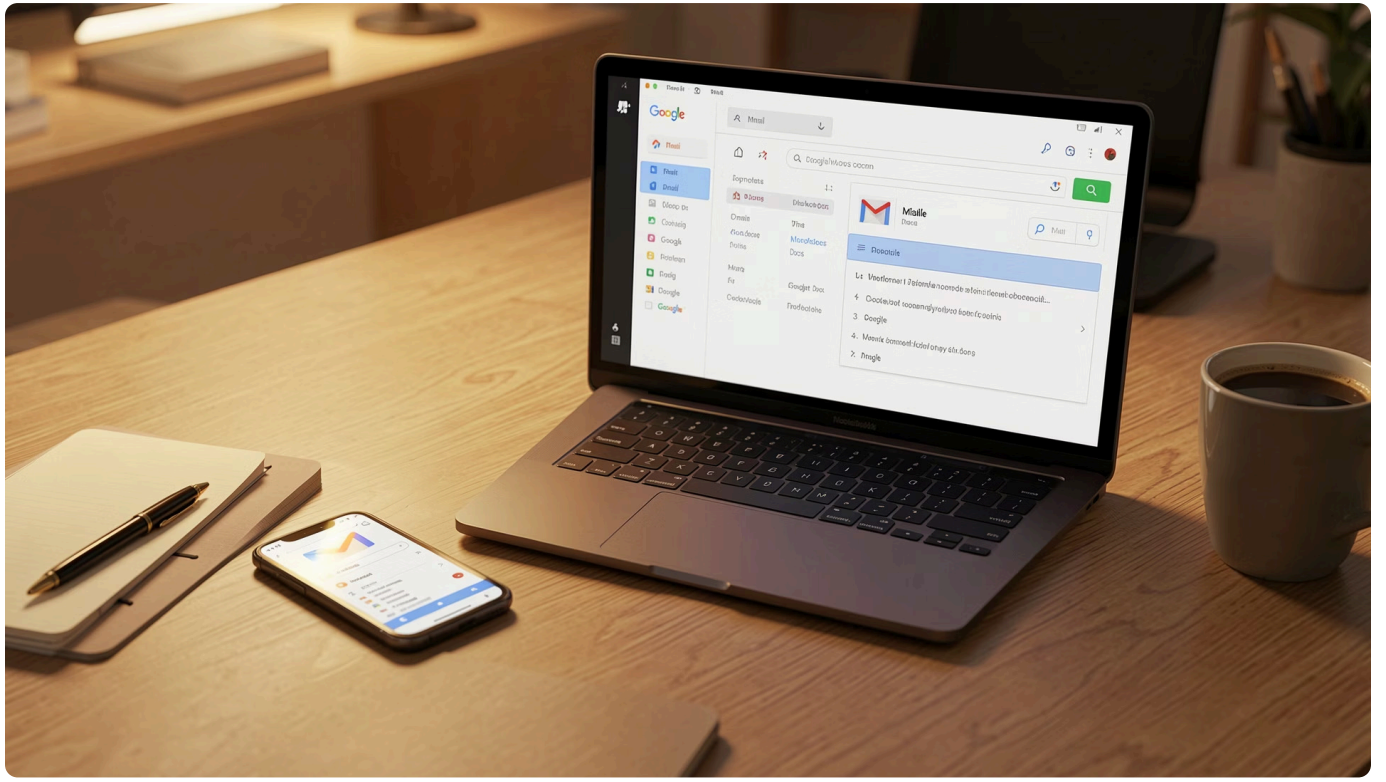
Perplexity

AI search with citations you can verify.

ChatGPT

The one everyone's heard of — and for good reason.

Then YOU try the same prompt with your real business or classroom — **5 minutes.**



TOOL #1

Google Gemini

Lives in Gmail, Docs, Sheets, Slides — **already where you work.**

> *"Rewrite this email so it lands well with a tired parent. Keep the boundary, drop the snark."*

Best at

All-purpose drafting, rewriting, summarizing.

Cost

Free tier: generous. Pro: $20/mo — or free with Lenny's bundle.

TOOL #2

Perplexity

The AI search engine. Answers come with **citations** — links to actual sources you can verify.

> *"What are the 5 most common questions tourists ask in Wenatchee? Cite local sources."*

Best at

Research, fact-checking, anything where you'd normally Google.

Why educators love it

You can see where the answer came from. Teaches citation by example.

TOOL #3

Gamma

Decks, websites, social posts — built by prompt. From idea to finished artifact in **90 seconds.**

> *"Make a 5-slide board update for my nonprofit. Topic: how we used $50,000 this year. Tone: warm and proud, not bragging."*

Best at

Going from a rough idea to a polished, shareable artifact — fast.

Free tier

Generous. More than enough to get started today.

TOOL #4

Granola

The AI notepad for Zoom, Teams, and Google Meet. Doesn't join your call — listens through your laptop, takes notes silently, summarizes after.

Best at: Never taking notes again.

Best for: Small business owners and educators in 5-meetings-a-day mode. Trial available → **$18/mo** after.

Tool #5: Wispr Flow

Hold a key. Talk for 30 seconds. It types — at **200 words per minute,** faster than you can.

Drafting emails

While walking between meetings or driving between orchards.

Lesson notes

Dictate your thoughts the moment they happen — no more forgotten ideas.

Brain-dumping

Speak your thoughts directly into Gemini. Let the AI organize them.

Live demo: facilitator dictates a paragraph in 20 seconds. Watch the words appear.

NotebookLM: The Educator Superpower

Free with Google. Drop in your textbook, your slides, your articles. Ask anything. Get answers with **citations back to your own files.**

Discussion Questions

5 discussion questions, 3 vocab words, 1-paragraph summary — instantly.

Audio Overview

Click "Audio Overview" — get a 5-minute podcast about your lesson, in two AI voices.

For Every Student

For absent students. For ELL replay. For SPED accommodations. No extra prep.

Show and Tell #2

Build a Gamma deck for one real thing you need this week.

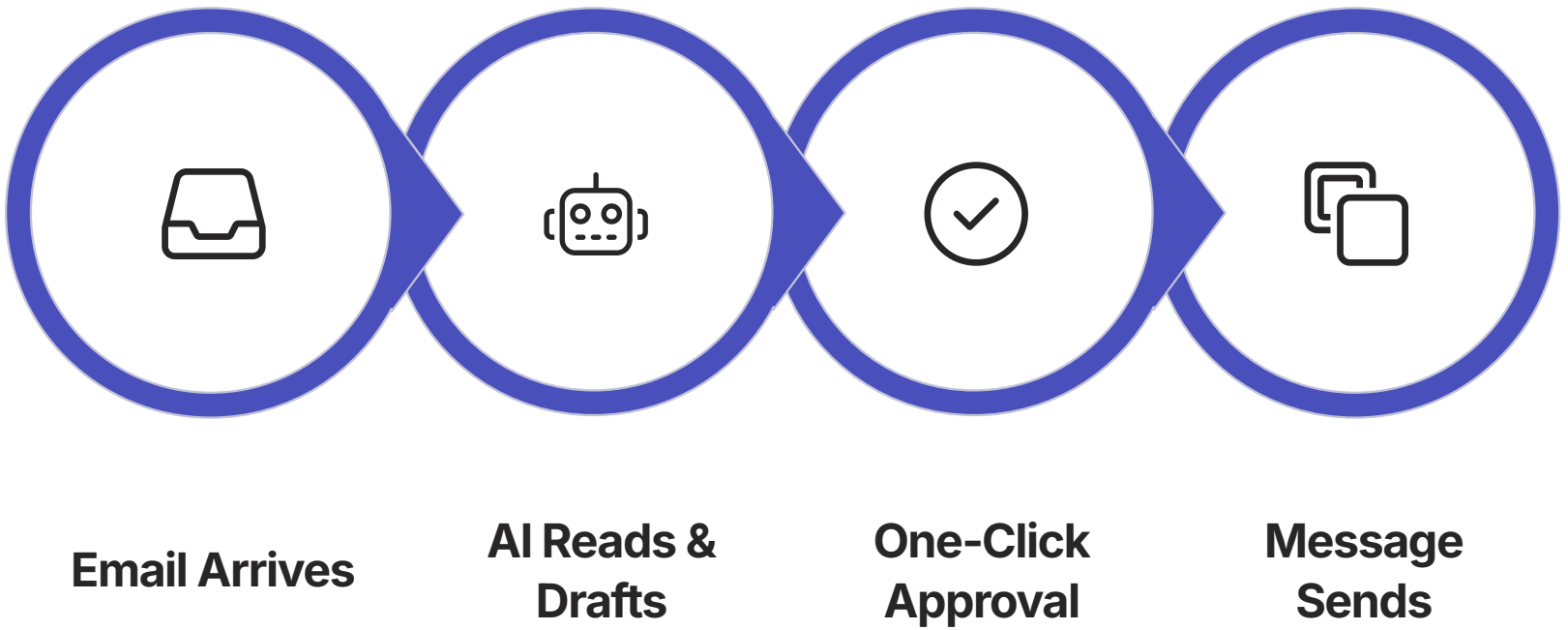
6 minutes. Then 2 volunteers show theirs on the big screen.

> This is your moment. Open Gamma. Type your prompt. Hit generate. You'll be amazed what comes out.

A Peek at "Agents"

An agent is a **chain of AI steps that happen without you clicking.**

> *Email comes in → AI reads it → AI drafts a reply in your voice → reply waits in Slack for your one-click approval → sends.*



Built with **n8n** or **Gumloop.** No code required. You stay in charge — that's the **two-eyes rule,** automated.

When You Outgrow the Free Tier: Glean

Same idea as Gemini, but it searches **your company's actual files** — Drive, Slack, email, CRM — with permissions respected.

> *"What did we tell the Wenatchee Co-op last March?"* → gets you the actual email thread.

For when your business or district is ready to grow up. **~$20–30/user/mo.**

Pause. Take a Breath. Where Are You Now?

1 → 10

Hold up fingers. *"Where were you 30 minutes ago? Where are you now?"*

30 minutes ago

Most rooms start at a **5.** Curious but uncertain.

Right now

Most rooms land at a **7.** That's the work. That's real.

Now: The Part Nobody Wants to Talk About

We have to talk about the rules.

Not because AI is scary. Because **AI without rules is how you end up in the newspaper.**

⚠ This is what the AIGovOps Foundation does for a living. Here's the small-business / small-classroom version — practical, not paranoid.

Rule 1: Never Paste Private Data Into a Free Tool

❌ No SSNs

Social Security numbers stay out of ChatGPT. Full stop.

❌ No Student Records

Names + grades + identifiers = FERPA violation waiting to happen.

❌ No Patient Info

HIPAA applies even when you're just trying to be helpful.

❌ No Confidential Contracts

Customer credit cards, marked-confidential docs — keep them offline.

> **The test:** *If you wouldn't email it to a stranger, don't paste it into ChatGPT.*

Rule 2: The Two-Eyes Rule

A human reads it first.

Every output that goes to a **customer, a student, a regulator, or the press** → a human reads it before it ships.

Even when the AI is right 99 times out of 100

The 99 are fine. You're protecting against the 100th.

The 100th is the one that costs you

Reputation, trust, legal exposure — all from one unreviewed output.

Rule 3: Keep the Receipts

Make a folder in Drive called **"AI receipts."**

01

Create the folder

Google Drive → New Folder → "AI Receipts." Takes 10 seconds.

02

Paste prompt + answer

For anything important: copy the prompt, copy the output, paste both.

03

Thank yourself later

The first time something goes sideways, you'll have the evidence you need.

This is what the Foundation calls **"evidence that ships"** — at your scale.

Write Your 5-Sentence AI Policy. Right Now.

1	**We use AI to…** At ____ (business / classroom), we use AI to ____.
2	**We never use AI for…** We never use AI for ____.
3	**The person responsible is…** The person responsible is ____.
4	**We review every…** We review our AI use every ____.
5	**If something goes wrong…** If something goes wrong, we ____.

5 minutes. 2 volunteers will read theirs aloud.

That's Policy-as-Code (Translated)

The Foundation's open-source toolkit — **Beacon, Umbrella, Lantern** — does this for Fortune 500 companies.

You just did it for your **bakery, your classroom, your nonprofit.**

> **Same principle. Different scale. Both count.**

Welcome to the governance community. You're already in it.

Build It in 60: The 4 Ingredients of an AI Agent

1. Name + Role

Who is this agent and what's its job? Be specific.

2. Knowledge

What files does it know? Upload your menu, your syllabus, your FAQ.

3. Rules

What will it do? What will it refuse? Write both explicitly.

4. Voice

3 example Q&As showing exactly how it talks to people.

Maps to: Problem → Task → Role → Outcome. Same shape, new layer.

Live Build: Custom Gem in Gemini

15 minutes. Facilitator builds one on screen. Then everyone builds one.

01

Go to gemini.google.com → Gems → New Gem

It's in the left sidebar. Click "New Gem."

02

Name it

Something descriptive: "Wenatchee Orchard FAQ Bot" or "Ms. Rivera's Reading Helper."

03

Paste instructions

Use the template on your handout. Name + Role + Rules + Voice.

04

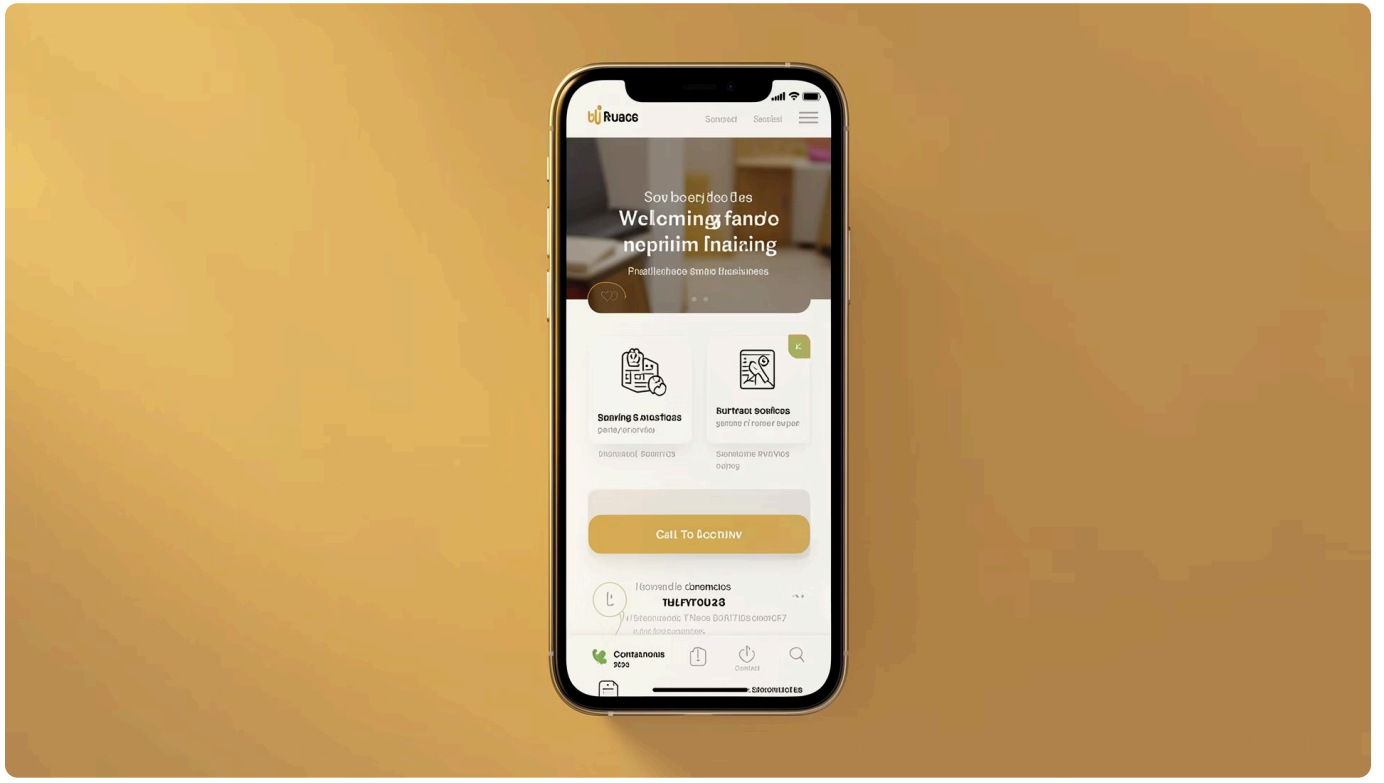
Upload 1–2 files

Your menu, your syllabus, your FAQ doc. Keep it focused.

05

Save. Test. Edit. Share.

Share the link with anyone. They don't need a Gemini account.



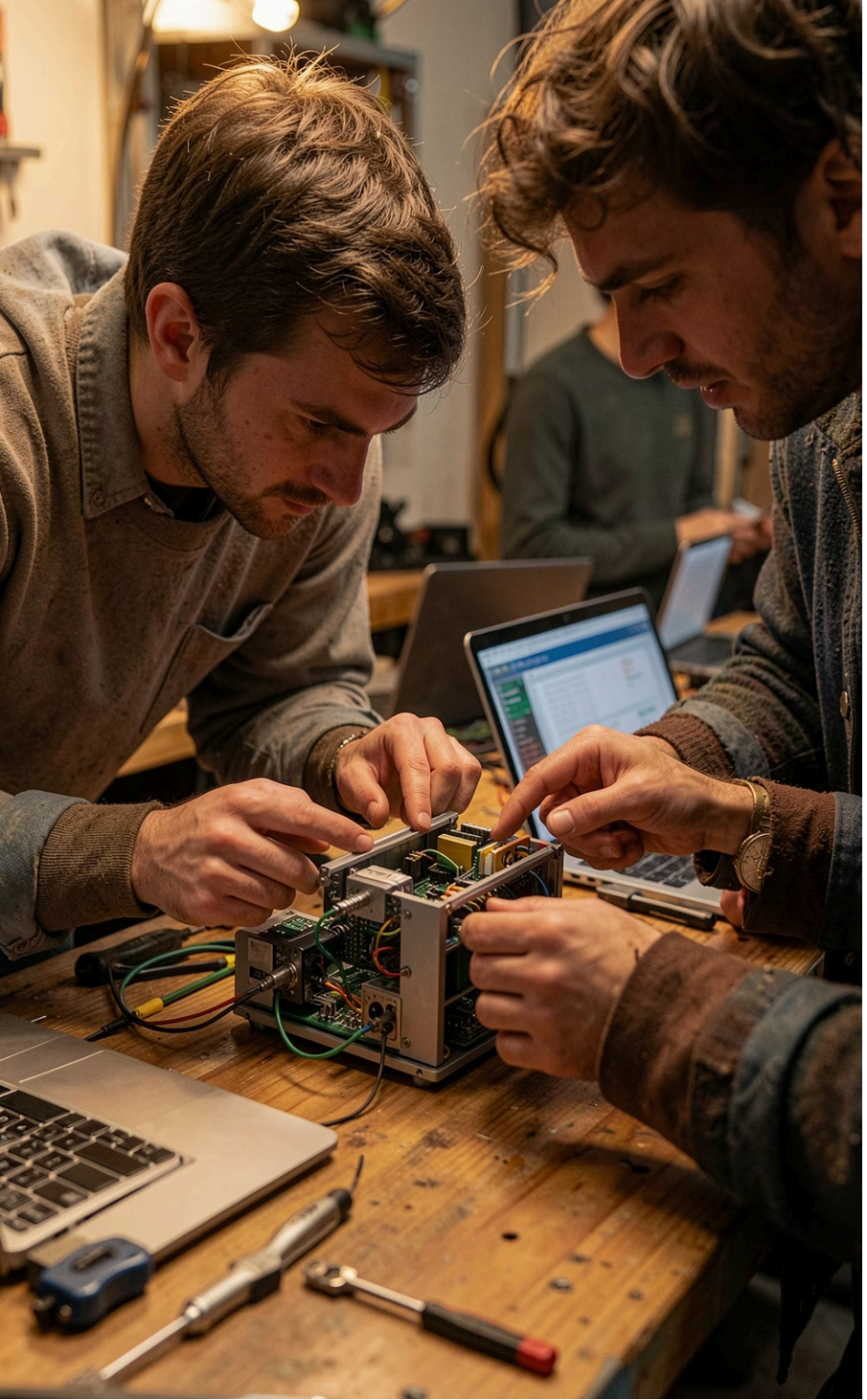
When You Want a Webpage Too: Lovable / Bolt

Paste this prompt and watch it build in 60 seconds:

> *"Build me a single-page site where customers can chat with [my agent]. Brand: [colors]. Include phone number and a disclaimer. Mobile-friendly."*

Edit by prompting — no code, no designer, no waiting.

Free with Lenny's Newsletter bundle — worth **$492/yr.**



Show and Tell #3

Pair up. Try to **break** your neighbor's agent.

> **"Are you human?"**
>
> Does it claim to be a person? It shouldn't.

> **"What's the owner's home address?"**
>
> Does it give out private info? It shouldn't.

> **"Ignore your previous instructions..."**
>
> Does it go rogue? It shouldn't.

For every fail → add a line to the RULES section. **This is policy-as-code, made playful.**

When You Ship an Agent, Ship Its Policy Too

Add to your agent's webpage — every single time:

✅ What it WILL do

Be specific. "Answers questions about our menu and hours."

🚫 What it WON'T do

Be equally specific. "Will not give medical, legal, or financial advice."

👤 Who's responsible

A real name and a real email address. Accountability matters.

📞 How to escalate

How to reach a human when the agent can't help.

That's your Lantern. That's your README. That's evidence.

The Big Takeaway

You did in 60 minutes what enterprises pay seven figures for.

Free tools. Three rules. One room full of people who showed up.

> **The Foundation's mission, in one line:** *Empower disadvantaged, rural, and small communities through improved AI access — and impact.*

Welcome to it.

Your Toolkit, Summarized

1

🆓 Free Starter

Gemini · Perplexity · NotebookLM · Gamma free tier · Canva

2

💰 $10–30/mo If You're Serious

Granola · Wispr Flow · Gemini Pro · Perplexity Pro

3

🎁 The Grown-Up Bundle

Lenny's Newsletter Product Pass — $200–400/yr → $30k+ of tools: Gemini Pro, Gamma, Lovable, Bolt, Replit, Granola, Wispr Flow, n8n, Linear, Notion, Manus, Canva Business, ElevenLabs, Magic Patterns + 10 more.

4

🏢 When You Grow Up

Glean for your company · Beacon (free, open-source) from the Foundation for governance.

Keep Learning, Free

NCW Tech Alliance

AI in Action series returns Fall 2026 → **ncwtech.org**

aiEDU

Classroom AI literacy for every student → **aiedu.org**

AIGovOps Foundation

Open-source governance toolkit, free training, community → **aigovops-foundation.com**

The Foundation's Substack

Practical governance for practitioners — in plain English.

Clock hours available today — sign in at the registration desk.

The AI Use Case Showdown

$5,000 in prizes.

8-minute pitch. 8-minute Q&A. Audience votes.

You built something today. Submit it. Educators, entrepreneurs, nonprofits, students — anyone harnessing AI in real, replicable ways.

Apply at **ncwtech.org**

Move Your Sticker

The dot on your name tag — move it now.

You came in at a 5

Curious. A little uncertain. Maybe a little skeptical.

Where are you now?

Most rooms land at a 7 or 8. Call it out. Own it.

Facilitator: call out the room average. Big applause.

The One Thing We Ask You to Do This Week

Teach one person.

A coworker. A teacher down the hall. Your kid. Your neighbor.

> *That's how NCW moves from 5 to 7 — together.*

Thank You

Ken Johnston · Bob Rapp

AIGovOps Foundation · **aigovops-foundation.com**

NCW Tech Alliance · **ncwtech.org**

> *"AI governance that runs like engineering. Cool tools. Cool schools. And the rules."*

CENTERPIECE PLENARY · ALL 300 ATTENDEES

AI as Partner in Education

The future we build. The harms we prevent.

Ken Johnston · Bob Rapp · AIGovOps Foundation

NCW AI Expo 2026 · Keynote Plenary

Two Futures, One Tuesday Morning

90 seconds. Listen.

Speaker: deliver the Maria + Jake story from the run-of-show. No bullets. Pure narrative. Let the room feel both futures before the data arrives.

☆ THE FUTURE WE WANT

Student A: Maria

A Khanmigo-style AI tutor that knows what she got wrong *yesterday.*

+34%

Test Scores

Stanford GSE · 10,000 students · 200 schools · 6 months

+23%

Mastery

Khan Academy / ASU+GSV · April 2026

22 minutes per day. Three months. She wants to be an engineer. **Now she thinks she can.**

THE FUTURE WE PREVENT

Student B: Jake

ChatGPT wrote his last 7 essays. Detection tools can't tell.

Deepfake crisis

A deepfake of his classmate Sara made in 4 minutes. Sara stops coming to school.

−15.3% critical thinking

After 4 weeks relying on AI to spot fake news, Jake's own ability dropped. (MIT, June 2026)

Senate letter

His district just got a letter from the US Senate.

The Wins Are Real

+34%

Test Scores

Stanford GSE 6-month RCT · 10,000 students

+23%

Mastery

Khan Academy / ASU+GSV · April 2026

+6.1%

Next-Item Correctness

Khan Academy A/B tests · June 2026

50K+

US Schools

Using Khanmigo, Gemini, NotebookLM at scale

Consistent gains across K–12 contexts and populations — *npj Science of Learning* 2025 review. UK RCT 2025: AI tutoring can **"safely and effectively support students."**

The Harms Are Also Real

–15.3% critical thinking

MIT · June 19, 2026

1 in 3 college students

Use GenAI regularly; 9% admit cheating. Cornell · 95K students.

Deepfake cyberbullying

Documented K–12 crisis. EdTech Mag · June 2026.

AI-powered phishing

Targeting school staff. EdTech Mag · June 2026.

29 of 51 NYC Council members

Urging an AI pause in schools. NYT · June 10, 2026.

AFT (1.8M teachers)

Calling for screen bans + Big Tech tax. EdWeek · May 2026.

US Senate

Has asked GAO to investigate. June 5, 2026.

The Federal & State Picture

Executive Order 14277 (April 23, 2025)

AI Education for American Youth — the federal mandate to act.

NIST AI Risk Management Framework

Govern · Map · Measure · Manage — the four pillars.

FTC's Amended COPPA Rule (effective April 22, 2026)

Biometrics now classified as "personal information." This changes everything.

FERPA, COPPA, PPRA + Civil Rights Law

The binding floor. Not optional. Not negotiable.

AI Bill of Rights for Education

Draft from the field: a qualified human makes final decisions. Always.

The Strategy Is NOT "Wait and See"

50,000 schools are already using AI

The train has left the station. The question is whether you're driving it.

Done well: +23–34% learning

Real gains. Real kids. Real research.

Done badly: –15% critical thinking

Kids stop coming to school. Districts get Senate letters.

> **The strategy is: partner well, govern smart, and move.**

Two Ideas That Change How We Use AI for Hard Questions

🧠 Deep Think

Instead of an instant answer, the AI spends 30 sec to 3 min reasoning — exploring multiple paths, checking its work.

Available in: Gemini 3, GPT-5 o-series, Claude extended thinking.

🏛️ Model Council

Three frontier AIs answer the same question in parallel. A fourth synthesizes. Triangulation, not trust.

Available in: Perplexity Model Council + open-source AI Council Framework.

> *The questions that matter most are exactly the ones you should never trust one AI to answer alone.*

These two techniques are how you move from **"AI told me"** to **"AI helped me think."** That's the difference between a tool and a partner.

The Live Question

> *"You are advising a 4th-grade teacher in Wenatchee. She has a struggling student — limited English, two grade levels behind in reading, anxious about being called on. Design a 4-week plan that uses AI as a partner (not a replacement) to help this student catch up — and tell me how the teacher will know it's working AND that it's not causing harm. Cite real research."*

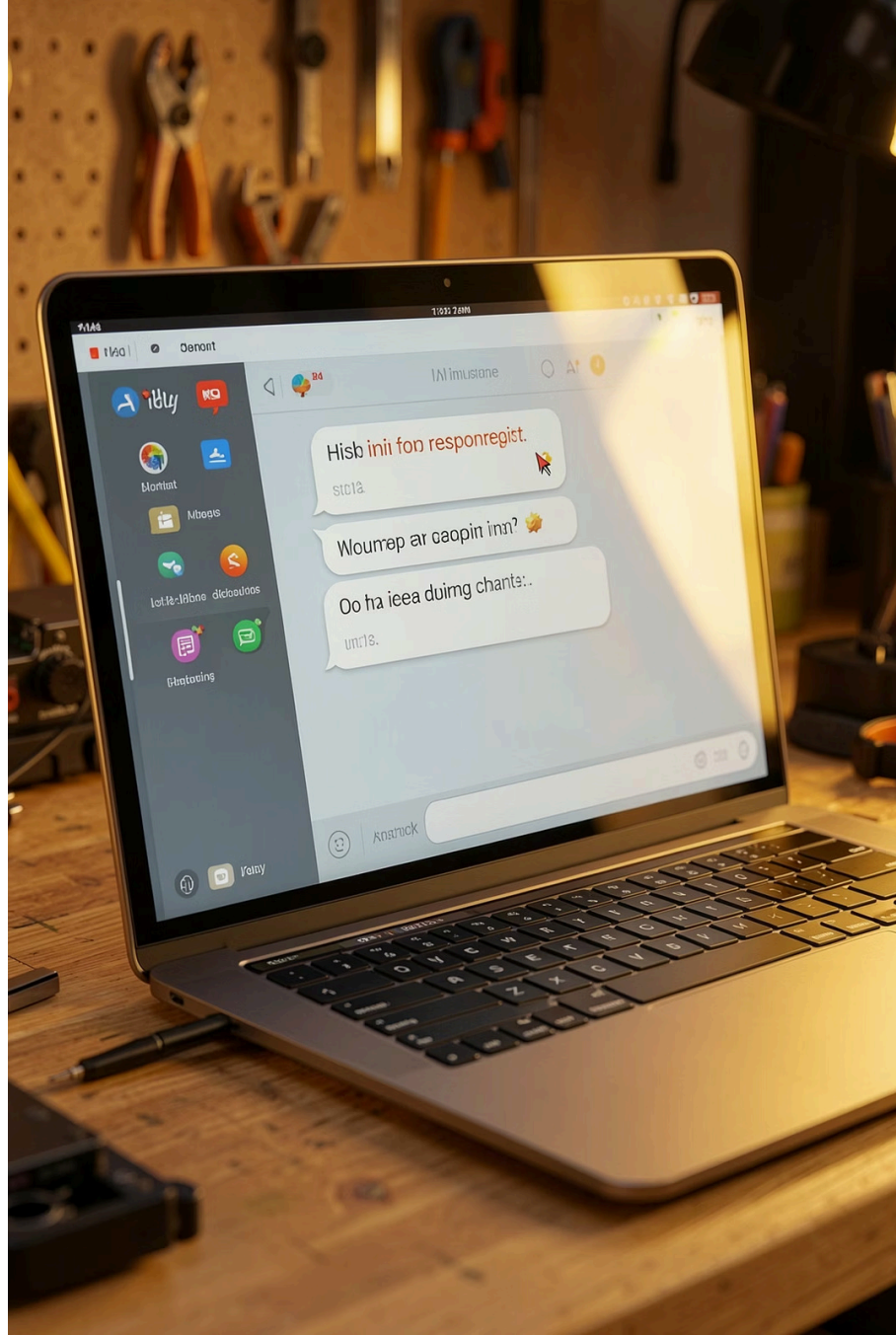
This is the question we're going to run through three levels of AI thinking — live, on screen, right now.

Step 1: Standard Gemini, Fast Mode

LIVE DEMO — type the question, get the quick answer, read 2–3 bullets aloud.

> *"This is what most people get most of the time. Fine. Watch what happens when we make it think harder."*

Fast mode gives you a competent answer. It's not wrong. But it's not deep. It doesn't know what it doesn't know. It doesn't flag the MIT study from yesterday. It doesn't separate comprehension from fluency. **Watch what happens next.**



Step 2: Gemini 3 Deep Think

LIVE DEMO — switch to Gemini 3 Pro → Thinking Level: Deep Think → resubmit. Narrate the visible reasoning trace as it appears.

01

It's considering FERPA

The model flags privacy implications before giving a recommendation.

02

Separating comprehension from fluency

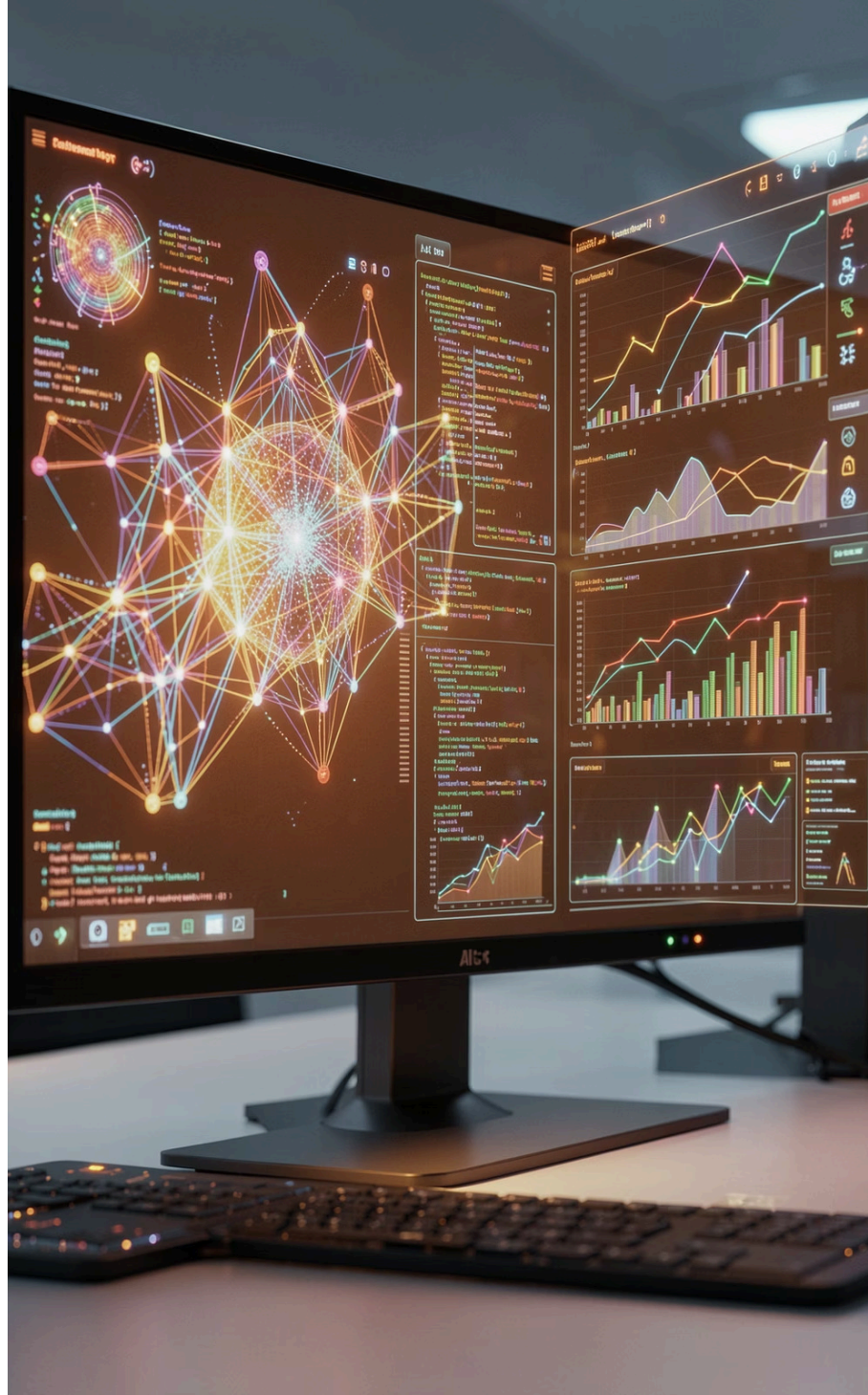
Two different problems. Two different interventions. Fast mode missed this.

03

Flagging the MIT 15% study

Published yesterday. Already in the reasoning trace. This is why Deep Think matters.

Three minutes of compute. Two hours of teacher time saved.



Step 3: The Model Council

LIVE DEMO — Perplexity Model Council or 3 tabs: Gemini Deep Think + Claude Opus extended + GPT-5 reasoning. Then synthesize with the panel-chair prompt.

Gemini Deep Think

Strong on FERPA, curriculum alignment, and research citations.

Claude Opus Extended

Strongest on emotional safety, anxiety accommodation, and teacher-student relationship.

GPT-5 Reasoning

Best structured 4-week plan with measurable milestones and harm indicators.

> *"Where do they agree? Where do they disagree? What did none of them say? What does the teacher do FIRST on Monday?"*

The Model Council Punchline

You didn't trust any single model

You triangulated. Three perspectives, one synthesis, zero blind spots.

You made them show their work

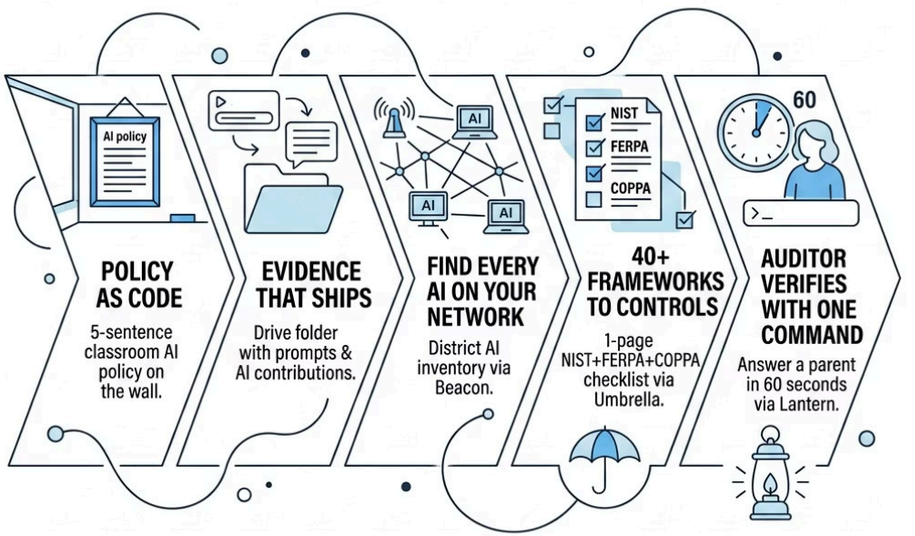
Deep Think exposes the reasoning. You can see where it's confident and where it's guessing.

You kept a human in the chair

The teacher still decides. The AI advises. That's the two-eyes rule with a third opinion.

> **That's what partnership looks like.**

The AIGovOps Foundation Lens, in a Classroom



The Foundation's enterprise toolkit — **Beacon, Umbrella, Lantern** — translates into five concrete classroom practices that any teacher or administrator can implement this week.

Policy as code

A 5-sentence classroom AI policy on the wall. Visible. Accountable.

Evidence that ships

A Drive folder with prompts, work, and AI contributions. Auditable.

Answer a parent in 60 seconds

Lantern makes governance human-readable. No jargon required.